

SUMMARY: SUMMARISING A PASSAGE IN A SPECIFIED NUMBER OF SENTENCES

Summary can be described as a shortened form of a long passage after removing all irrelevant ideas from the main points and giving a short account of the passage using your own words.

To summarize a passage in a specified number of sentences demands that one should pay attention to the instruction on the number of sentences each questions requires. Some questions demands that you summarize in one, two, or three sentences.

Ensure you write as instructed.

A sentence begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop.

THINGS TO NOTE FOR GOOD SUMMARY

1. Brevity: Your answer must be brief and straight to the point. No use of additional information apart from the main points.
2. Relevance: A candidate answer should be relevant to the points mentioned in the passage.
3. Clarity: This means that students are expected to put down their answers clearly.
4. Originality: Your answers should be written in your own words to avoid the error of mindless lifting.
5. Identify the topic sentences: The topic sentences are the main points in the paragraphs of the passage which are mostly found in the first or last sentence of a paragraph.
6. Write your answers in complete sentences

CAUSES OF LOSS OF MARK IN SUMMARY WRITING

1. Mindless lifting of words from the passage. This means copying down the exact words and expressions of the writer.
2. Phrases and incomplete sentences. In summary, your answers should be written in complete sentences not in phrases.
3. Writing more than required number of sentences.
4. Grammatical/expression errors.
5. Wrong use of preamble or the introductory statement that does not flow with the sentences.

Exercise

Answer the summary questions in unit 7 of your New Concept English

- i. In one sentence, what is the reason for the war in the passage?
- ii. In two sentences, one for each, explain the two types of war the writer feels could have made sense.

Reference : New Oxford Secondary English Course for Senior Secondary Schools by Ayo Banjo et al.